



ILLUSTRATION BY RAJ VERMA

EQUIS and AMBA function as global “trust marks.” Out of 3,500 B-schools in India, fewer than three dozen hold any of these—a gap that directly affects credibility.

- Foreign students judge programmes by placement outcomes. Western schools maintain structured internship-to-job pipelines; Indian schools largely focus on domestic employers, limiting global visibility.
- Admissions linked to the CAT are unfamiliar abroad. Though many Indian schools now accept GMAT/GRE scores, their timelines and communication remain opaque. Western

schools, in contrast, market aggressively through global fairs and personalised outreach.

- Research capability drives reputation. Harvard reports annual revenues exceeding \$1 billion; INSEAD’s annual revenue is €324 million. Indian B-schools operate on far smaller research budgets. Expanding corporate and foundation grants, endowments, and research chairs is essential for academic heft and global rankings.

The transformation has begun. With IIM Ahmedabad leading the charge abroad with opening of its

Dubai campus, IIM Kozhikode and others internationalising admissions by creating supernumerary seats, and a few B-schools running dual-degree and international immersion programmes and extending overseas partnerships, the contours of a global Indian management-education ecosystem are emerging. Collectively, these steps mark the beginning of India’s integration into the global management education network.

Road Ahead

To convert interest into actual inflows, India must act on both policy and institutional fronts. It must introduce a two- to three-year visa for graduates of accredited programmes to enable employment here. It must also accelerate international hiring and visiting appointments; use accreditations as quality signals.

Other avenues that can be explored are expansion of 1+1 dual-degree models and guaranteed exchanges or internships with reputed global schools. Besides, a government-industry-backed India Global MBA Fellowship can be launched to attract top international students.

Establishing a Global Career Services Consortium connecting leading Indian schools with recruiters in London, New York, Dubai, and Singapore, will be of immense help. And, there must be unified branding. A global “Study Management in India” campaign to highlight affordability, English-medium delivery, and exposure to a fast-growing economy will boost enrolments.

With determined execution, India’s top B-schools could raise their foreign student ratio from under 2-3% to 10-15% within five years. This would transform classrooms, build international alumni networks, and enhance India’s global standing. **BT**

Views are personal